

tance, eliminating the need of actually touching them. The new gesture input technology will be the first of its kind effort by the Redmond-based technology giant which will change the way we operate devices and interactive displays in the future.

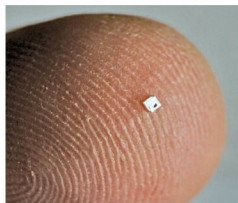
Reportedly, Microsoft is planning to implement the gesture input technology using an electronic bracelet rather than the traditional method wherein a camera is used to track movements.

Since the technology does not rely on a camera, users would not necessarily have to be physically present in the same room as the gadget they desire to control. It must be noted that start-ups like Ring & Fin have already introduced such gesture recognition, but this is for the first time that a company as massive as Microsoft is looking to venture into the territory. Anticipation is therefore obviously notches higher.

Bladder-pressure sensors to replace catheters

The Foundation For Scientific and Industrial Research, in collaboration with Sunnaas Hospital in Norway, have now come out with a tiny bladder-pressure sensor that could provide much needed relief to patients suffering from the neurological disorder that bars them from controlling their bladder for long. When effective and commercially available, the technology could replace traditional catheters.

In Norway, over 200,000 people



A tiny bladder-pressure sensor

suffer from this disorder. Taking due cognisance, SINTEF, an independent research organisation in Scandinavia, has finally developed a pressure sensor that might help patients. Current method makes use of catheters to make the relevant bladder-pressure measurements. A catheter is inserted inside the urethra, therefore the process is very uncomfortable for the patient. Also, it is not very reliable.

SINTEF's miniature sensor, on the other hand, can be easily inserted into a patient's body through a thin needle. The process does not lead to any discomfort and is, quite frankly, a welcome change from traditional catheters.

Further, patients can go out and perform their daily tasks involving natural movements, something that is very restricted in the case of earlier technologies. The bladder-pressure sensor is connected to control systems via thin wires as of now. However, researchers are working on wireless technology which, in the future, could allow measurements at regular intervals using even smartphones.

Now a shape-shifting smartphone

Wearable devices, which can be monitored via devices such as tabs, phones or computers made news this year in many recent exhibitions. But so far, no smartphone has been made wearable or shape changeable. Not any more, since scientists are reportedly developing new smartphones that can transform their shapes from that of an armband to a phone, or a tablet, to best suit your style or need.

The gen-next smartphones will be able to quickly transform



Shape-shifting smartphone—Paddle

their shapes. Researchers at Hasselt University iMinds in Belgium have developed a prototype smartphone called the 'Paddle.' It is a single gadget that can be transformed physically into different shapes. The gadget is inspired by the famous Rubik's Magic Puzzle, which is a device that comprises eight square tiles and can be folded or unfolded to form various shapes.

According to a Fast Company report, Raf Ramakers, a PhD student in human computer interaction at the university, said, "At the moment our Paddle prototype supports around 15 different shapes, but this number increases every day as we are including more and more shapes of the original Rubik's Magic Puzzle."

The device can be transformed into a book, whose pages you can leaf through to read. The users who need to scroll through a list can simply turn the phone into a bracelet and roll through. It can also be turned into an armband when you need to jog. If the Paddle is completely unfolded, it becomes nearly the size of an iPad. However, when it is folded up, it can become smaller than an iPhone.